Faction Tracker

Faction Domains

The Faction Tracker is used to record the power and influence of a faction. Each faction is ranked across four key domains, each scored from 0 to 10: Influence, Resource, Stability, Agency. These domains are interconnected— increasing one comes at the cost of another.

- **Influence** – The aim of every faction is to increase its *Influence Score* in order to expand control. This is represented by *Faction Feats* which are selected anytime the score is increased. If a faction loses an *Influence Point*, they also lose one of their Feats.
- **Resource** – *The Resource Score* represents the ingoing and outgoing assets of the faction. This might be access to wealth, manpower, materials, trade goods, or magic etc…. The faction can expend *Resource Points* to increase the other trackers.
- **Stability** – The *Stability Score* represents the internal cohesion, loyalty, leadership control, and resistance to internal collapse. The higher this score is, the easier things become for the faction. If the faction does not have enough stability, the faction may start to break apart and lose its influence on the world.
- **Agency** – The *Agency Score* represents the faction's ability to take meaningful action, enforce decisions, and implement goals. This might look like influencing a king's decision or committing a highway robbery. How much faction can do is determined by this tracker. The faction can expend *Agency Points* to increase its Resource or Influence Score.

Faction Actions

Anytime the GM chooses (once per session should be the maximum), the faction gains 1 *Resource Point* and a number of actions equal to its *Influence Score*. Those action can be used to do the following:

- **Redistribute** – Expend 1 *Resource Point*, gain 1 *Agency* or *Stability Point*.
- **Quest** – Expend 1 *Agency Point*, roll a Quest Check to get more resources (*DC = 20 - Stability Score)*. On a success, gain 1d4+1 *Resources Points*. Expending additional *Agency Points* adds +2 to the roll.
- **Impact** – Expend 2 Agency Points, steal 2 *Resource Points* and remove 1 *Stability Point* from another faction. If the target faction is a parent faction, steal 3 *Resource Points* and 2 *Stability Points* instead.

- **Expand** – Roll an Expand Check (*DC = 20 + Influence Score - Stability Score*). On a success, gain +1 *Influence Point* and choose a new *Faction Feat*. The *Stability Score* also becomes half the Influence Score (rounded down). On a Fail, the Stability Score becomes 0. Expending Resource Points adds +1 to the roll, while expending Agency Points adds +2.

Loyalty and Interacting With Players

Sometimes, the adventuring party will interact with organizations often enough to form partnerships. This is tracked through the *Loyalty Score* on a scale from 0 to 10. Anytime the PCs successfully help a faction or its members, they gain 1d4+1 *Loyalty Points* which can be expended to gain access to the *Faction Feats* that faction has selected. The GM can also choose to add any number of points to the *Resource*, *Stability*, or *Agency* Scores depending on the outcomes of the assistance. It may be that a faction and players become enemies. In that case, the loyalty is never gained points cannot be used until the relationship is mended. Whatever the case may be, expending loyalty with a faction usually requires players to be interacting with a related NPC operating in the locations controlled by the faction.

Creating and Flavoring a Faction

An emergent faction should start with 1 *Faction Feat*, 1 *Influence*, 1 *Resource*, 1 *Stability*, and 2 *Agency Points*. Otherwise, an older and more established faction can have any amount of points in any domain. Just be sure to select a number of Faction Feats equal to the *Influence Score*.

Along with selecting a name for the organization, GMs may also find it helpful to write down 1-3 traits that communicate the personality of the faction. These traits should be general 1 word adjectives like careless, secretive, or self-righteous for instance. This might be helpful when players interact with new NPCs and give an overall sense how the faction and its members are differentiated from other organizations in the world.

All factions and organizations have a goal. Write down a sentence or two describing the faction's mission. Perhaps the goal is to “Summon the Demon-Lord, Exanath” or “Maintain control over the Ulari Kingdom”. Whatever it is, it should give a direction that the faction is always working toward. The mission does not need to stay the same either. If the faction fails or succeeds in its goal, the organization can always move on.

Faction Feats

Faction Feats are traits offered by the faction that the players can use by expending loyalty (amount determined by the feat). They also indicate the type of organization the faction is. A list of pre-existing feats have been sorted into one of four categories: Martial, Intrigue, Commerce, and Magic. Mix and match feats from across any section, or create your own feats, to create interesting and detailed factions. A faction can have a number of *Faction Feats* equal to its *Influence Score*.

MARTIAL

- **Hireling** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per session*
  The faction grants the party a reliable NPC ally. This NPC will assist the party in combat or travel as long as 1 Loyalty Point is spent each session.
- **Medic** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per use*
  A medic can tend to a party member, granting 1d6 temporary hit points per Loyalty spent for the remainder of the session
- **War Mounts** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty*
  The faction provides a trained, durable mount suitable for battle. Mounts remain until slain or abandoned.
- **Guard Detail** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty per session*
  A squad of guards accompanies the players, defending them from threats and adding visible authority.
- **Siegebreaker Permit** - *Cost: 5 Loyalty*
  Grants access to siege equipment or support—battering rams, mobile cover, etc.—for major assaults.
- **Drill Sergeant** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per character*
  Characters gain +1 to all attack rolls for the remainder of the session after faction-led combat drills.
- **Battle Insight** - *Cost: 5 Loyalty*
  Learn a non-humanoid creature's resistances, immunities, and possible attacks but not damage values
- **Repairs** - *Cost: Varies*
  Have damaged gear, vehicles, or infrastructure restored. Loyalty Cost is set by the DM based on complexity or rarity.
- **Combat Lessons** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty per character*
  Gain proficiency in a weapon, armor, or combat-related tool for one combat encounter. Does not stack.
- **Training** - *Cost: 6 Loyalty*
  One player learns a new skill, tool, weapon, or armor proficiency (permanently) justified by the faction's expertise.

INTRIGUE

- **Informant Web** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty*
  Gain a tip about a local threat, secret meeting, or hidden opportunity. The faction might also offer to alert the party to something they wouldn't have known otherwise.
- **Blackmail File** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty*
  Leverage a dossier of compromising information. For one session, the party gains advantage on Persuasion and Intimidation checks against a specific target. Alternatively, they learn one secret fact about the NPC they didn't know before.
- **Red Herring** - *Cost: 5 Loyalty*
  Frame another faction or NPC or organization for a crime, scandal, or betrayal. The target suffers some kind of backlash or temporary loss of reputation or power (DM's discretion).
- **Safehouse Access** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty per session*
  Grants the party access to a secure hideout — shielded from magical scrying, bounty hunters, and patrols. Can house and heal the party in secrecy.
- **Disguise Kit** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per player*
  Receive professionally tailored disguises complete with accents, documents, and social cues, granting advantage on Deception and Performance checks for maintaining the ruse.
- **Sleeper Agent** - *Cost: 6 Loyalty*
  The faction activates an embedded operative. Players choose a friendly NPC. That NPC is an agent of the faction and always has been. The location where this NPC resides is now considered under the control of the faction and other faction feats may be used whenever they are around.
- **Safe Passage** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty*
  Grants the party official-looking permits, travel documents, or noble credentials, allowing safe passage through most checkpoints or restricted areas. Alternatively, the faction offers access to a secret route through which the players may pass undetected.
- **Political Favor** - *Cost: 4 Loyalty*
  Temporarily sway a local authority figure, court or council to the party's side, granting temporary legal immunity, a one-time favor, or behind-the-scenes support. Alternatively, the players gain 2 loyalty with another faction.
- **Assassination Contract** - *Cost: 8 Loyalty*
  The faction tries to eliminate a single NPC with which it has no connection. High-ranking or well-protected NPCs may resist, trigger retaliation, or escape depending on DM discretion.
- **Inside Access** - *Cost: 4 Loyalty*
  The faction arranges backdoor access to a secured location. This grants the party either an alternate entry or exit route, or possibly removes some kind of obstacle such as disabling alarms, distracting guards and unlocked doors.

COMMERCE

- **Preferred Rates** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per use*
  Gain a 5% discount on goods or services per loyalty point with vendors affiliated with faction.
- **Letter of Credit** - *Cost: Varies*
  The faction arranges a recognized line of credit for the party, granting them an agreed amount of coinage. The debt must be repaid within a set timeframe or interest applies (DM's discretion). Loyalty Cost varies based on amount.
- **Cargo Contract** - *Cost: Varies*
  The faction assigns a merchant vessel or caravan to deliver goods to any destination of the party's choosing as long as the location resides within the faction's control. Loyalty Cost varies based on distance. Smuggling operations may cost more.
- **Black Market Access** - *Cost: 4 Loyalty*
  Grants the party access to illicit goods, services, or contacts such as stolen magic, poisons, smuggled items, or outlawed relics, depending on region.
- **Warehousing Rights** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty*
  The faction offers secure storage space for cargo, loot, or vehicles based on the operations of the faction. It can be accessed at any time at its designated location. The faction may ask for a money payment or the Loyalty Cost to be repaid in intervals.
- **Skilled Labor** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty per session*
  Players gain access to skilled workers such as builders, enchanters, or blacksmiths for long projects. This could reduce project time, grant advantage on checks, ect….
- **Appraiser** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty*
  A faction appraiser can evaluate artifacts, documents, magic items, weapons and armor, or similar objects revealing its approximate value, properties, and origins. It also exposes fakes or hidden enchantments.
- **Custom Goods** - *Cost: 8 Loyalty*
  Commission the crafting or modification of a specialized item or modification without monetary cost.
- **Investors** - *Cost: 4 Loyalty*
  The faction invests party funds on their behalf. Gains and/or losses are made after some time. (DM's discretion). If there is a loss, players regain 2 Loyalty Points.
- **Negotiator** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty per session*
  A skilled NPC represents the party in negotiations, the party gains advantage on Persuasion, Insight, and Deception checks during these negotiations/trials.

MAGIC

- **Guest Lecture** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty*
  A scholar, arcanist, or researcher teaches one character, granting advantage on any skill of their choice for the session.
- **Scroll Commission** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty per spell level*
  The faction produces a single-use scroll of any spell known to their order (DM's discretion).
- **Forbidden Texts** - *Cost: 6 Loyalty*
  The faction grants access to highly restricted knowledge—such as a lost ritual, forgotten history, or cursed item lore—with potential risks or side effects.
- **Loaned Relic** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty per session*
  Players may borrow a magic item, artifact, or research tool for the session. The item's power is determined by the faction.
- **Archive Access** - *Cost: 2 Loyalty per session*
  Players gain entrance to a hidden or prestigious archive. They may request lore such as monster ecology, royal records, or ancient maps, and receive valuable in-game knowledge.
- **Enhancements** - *Cost: Variable*
  Gain an enhancement or magical enchantment to any item or object. The more powerful the effect, the more Loyalty it costs (DM Discretion).
- **Proof of Theory** - *Cost: 5 Loyalty*
  The faction commits resources to help test one of the party's experimental ideas — magical, mechanical, or philosophical. If successful, the result becomes permanent (e.g. a new spell, item, or invention). If it fails, something unintended occurs (DM's discretion).
- **Research Funding** - *Cost: 4 Loyalty*
  The party receives a stipend and access to research materials. This reduces a project's time by half and may attract talented NPC collaborators (DM's discretion).
- **Experimental Brew** - *Cost: 1 Loyalty*
  Gain a potion or elixir developed by the faction such as (but not limited to) a healing potion. Effects are determined by region or research field and might include rare or unstable results.
- **Protective Wards** - *Cost: 3 Loyalty per session.*
  The faction provides protective glyphs and wards. Players can choose anything or anyone from amongst themselves, NPCs, weapons and armor, residences, or any physical object. It is protected from one type of damage, magical effect, or creature type of their choice.